AGA KHAN UNIVERSITY EXAMINATION BOARD

HIGHER SECONDARY SCHOOL CERTIFICATE

CLASS XII EXAMINATION

APRIL/ MAY 2017

English Compulsory Paper II

Time: 2 hours 05 minutes Marks: 60

AKU-EB May Examination 2017

INSTRUCTIONS

Please read the following instructions carefully.

1. Check your name and school information. Sign if it is accurate.

I agree that this is my name and school. **Candidate's signature**

2. RUBRIC. There are FOUR questions. Answer ALL questions. Question 3 offers TWO choices and Question 4 offers THREE choices. Attempt any ONE of the options in each.

3. When answering the questions:

   Read each question carefully.
   Use a black pointer to write your answers. DO NOT write your answers in pencil.
   Use a black pencil for diagrams. DO NOT use coloured pencils.
   DO NOT use staples, paper clips, glue, correcting fluid or ink erasers.
   Complete your answer in the allocated space only. DO NOT write outside the answer box.

4. The marks for the questions are shown in brackets ( ).

Q.1. (Total 17 Marks)

Read the passage carefully and then answer all the questions that follow:

Gulliver's Travels is a classic tale in English Literature. It has several parts but the first one, in which the main character, Gulliver, is shipwrecked and washes ashore on an island where everyone is about six inches tall, is the most famous and the most widely read of his adventures. The people on the island are tiny in size and are initially afraid of Gulliver, who appears to be a giant due to his size. They tie him up, but in time they come to trust and like him. His size helps them gain military strength, but there are several misunderstandings too, such as their assumption that Gulliver is trying to drown them when actually he is only putting out a fire. It is not easy to see eye to eye with someone different.

Dwarves* also appear in several fairy tales. Real life, though, can be very different, especially in Pakistan where people with dwarfism* are seen as misfits deserving of ridicule and of being baited. For many such people here, the opportunities of life are few, leaving many of them dejected.

Ali Arsalan's family, including his father, all have dwarfism, though his mother does not. "My paternal grandfather never saw anything wrong with my father," he says. "He saw him as a human being first and my mother never complained about the match either."

Arsalan is 21 years old and has studied up to Intermediate Part-I. "Now, I am in two minds as to whether to complete my studies or just forget about them," he says. "What am I going to do with a degree anyway? I know of another person like me who has done his B Com, and he drives a rickshaw." Arsalan, who can break-dance, is known as Little Michael Jackson among his friends; he has performed on stage occasionally but complains that while the other performers receive thousands of rupees for their work, he only gets one or two thousand. "Also, all the roles given to me are the non-serious ones," he says. "We are only required to make the audience laugh."

Reminded of the beloved radio performer Munni Baji, also characterised by dwarfism and admired by all her listeners, especially children, he reflects sadly that times have changed since people used to be respected for their talent. "Today's children harass and mock us. They chase after us, throwing stones at us while making fun of how we run," says Arsalan. "Munni Baji was very lucky. Not everyone is so lucky. Besides, she too is dead and forgotten now."

The person all members of this community find most inspiring is the late former Chief Justice of Pakistan, Nasim Hasan Shah, who also enjoyed the longest tenure of serving as a judge in the subcontinent. He also served as chairman of the Pakistan Cricket Board. "He is the prime example of what we can do if given an opportunity," says Mohammad Rizwan, who has a Master's degree in Islamiyat but works at a call centre. Rizwan used to face problems in getting to work every day, so he has designed a small motorbike for himself. He says, "the government has reserved a two percent job quota for us but we are denied even that. We don't want to become a burden on society. We are capable people, who can work as well as any other person." Last month, on International Dwarfism Day (October 25th), the Little People of Pakistan — an organisation run by people with dwarfism for the welfare of their community — organised a press conference to highlight their problems.

Source: Adapted from *A Problem of Perception* by The Daily DAWN

Dwarves*: individuals who have **dwarfism***, i.e. very short height

AKUEB May Examination 2017

a. What is the author's purpose in writing this article? Give TWO examples from the passage to support your answer. (4 Marks)

b. Discuss TWO economic and TWO social problems faced by people who have dwarfism. (4 Marks)

AKU-EB May Examination 2017

c. You must have read or heard a few stories where dwarfs were presented as characters. What is the difference between the way dwarfs are treated in fairy tales/ stories and real life? (3 Marks)

d. Summarise the passage in no more than 100 words. (4 Marks)

AKU-EB May Examination 2017

e. Add TWO details from your personal experiences which support the message of this passage. (2 Marks)

AKU-EB May Examination 2017

Q.2. (Total 10 Marks)

Read the passage carefully and fill in each of the blanks with **ONE** suitable word.

From the remote northern reaches 1_____ the Hindu Kush mountains to the Indus River delta in the south, and along the vast expanses of land on both sides of the Indus and its tributaries, exist traces of a rich past going back in antiquity.

Without doubt it is the largest ancient civilisation in the world, and yet no place else on earth 2_____ such amazing heritage under more threat than in Pakistan.

The earliest known 'food-producing' era (7,000 - 5,000 BC) 3_____ Mehrgarh in the 'kachi plains' of Balochistan. This is the oldest known 'settled village life' habitation, 4_____ crops were produced, skins tanned, copper mined and metal worked.

Life at Mehrgarh existed till 2,600 BC. It was roughly in this time period (3,300 - 2,800 BC) that the Harappan cities 5_____ the Ravi came about. Mohenjodaro and other Sindh cities by then were busy trading towns.

Experts 6 _____ that the cities of Multan, Hyderabad, Lahore and Peshawar came about in this time period. Afterwards, numerous smaller towns like Bhera 7_____. All of them were on major trading routes.

Immensely rich that Pakistan is in its heritage, there seems to be a reluctance to accept this heritage. History in Pakistan, it seems, 8_____from the time the Afghan king Mahmud of Ghazni attacked the areas that are Pakistan and beyond. In hundreds of years of Muslim rulers, foreign invaders cemented the mentality that their culture is superior to the local culture.

Today the ancient cities are fast disappearing. Even ancient sites like Mehrgarh, Harappa and Mohenjodaro are 9_____ of funds to preserve, let alone conserve.

As they shrink and get damaged 10_____ human intervention, Pakistan is losing its immensely rich heritage.

AKU-EB May Examination 2017

Q.3. (Total 15 Marks)

Compose a formal piece of writing of around 250-300 words on any **ONE** of the options **a** or **b**.

EITHER

a. You are interested in applying for a part-time job at a nearby library. Therefore, you have decided to send your résumé / CV along with a covering letter to the Head Librarian.

Your covering letter must include the following details:

- Why you are a suitable candidate for this job
- What changes you would like to bring about in the library to facilitate booklovers

Your résumé / CV should have the following:

- A realistic account of your education
- Any possible work experience
- Personal details (real names/ school names should **NOT** be used)
- Hobbies and extracurricular activities

OR

b. Child labour is the practice of engaging children (younger than 18 years of age) in economic activity, on part or full-time basis. The practice deprives children of their childhood and is harmful to their physical and mental development. Poverty, lack of good schools and large family structures are considered as important causes of child labour.

Recently, an NGO, Human Rights Watch, organised a seminar in your school to highlight the issue of child labour. They also announced that they would like to engage students in awareness-raising programmes to eradicate child labour. You have decided to contribute to this programme and have been given a task to compile a report on children working near your home and school.

Compose a report on the cases of child labour that you have observed for the Programme Manager of the Human Rights Watch. The report should mention the following.

- The places/ businesses which have employed children
- The age group of the employed children
- Suggested measures to improve the situation

Make your notes below. Write your final draft on pages 8, 9 and 10.

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Option _____

AKU-EB May Examination 2017

AKU-EB May Examination 2017

AKU-EB May Examination 2017

Q.4. (Total 18 Marks)

Write a composition of about 350-400 words on any **ONE** of the options **a, b** or **c.**
Remember to compose the final draft in complete sentences.

EITHER

a. "Open merit allows universities to identify the best candidates and acknowledge their extra efforts by preferring them over other candidates. Therefore, admission in colleges and universities should be based exclusively on merit, not on quotas."

Support OR negate the given statement with at least FOUR reasons and examples.

OR

b. Dairy farms breed cows and sell their milk. It has been observed that calves of dairy cows are separated from their mothers within the first 24 hours of their birth. Thus, all the milk produced by the cows enters the food market. The young calves are deprived of this milk and fed on sub-standard products and growth-enhancing hormones which artificially accelerate their growth. Similarly, when these calves become adults, their babies are separated from them in order to maximise the extraction of milk. This results in maximum profits for the farms because of increased sale of milk.

Write an analytical essay highlighting the mentioned issue. In your essay:

- Mention why separating young calves from their mothers is unethical
- Reasons of this practice
- How human beings are responsible for this situation
- What should be done to improve this situation

OR

c. Many educationists believe that testing children who are younger than 7 years is unethical. It puts unnecessary pressure on children and makes their childhood devoid of fun. They believe that formal tests should only be taken by those students who are more than 7 years of age. On the other hand, many educationists think that tests make children more responsible and attentive to learning from a young age.

Discuss your opinion regarding this issue. Support your opinion with FOUR appropriate reasons and examples.

Make your notes on the page given for rough work. Write your final draft on pages 12, 13 and 14.

AKU-EB May Examination 2017

Option _____

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END OF PAPER

Please use this page for rough work

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Please use this page for rough work

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